

RHYTHM REPAIR KIT

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #104

For many amateur and semi-pro jazz musicians, something as seemingly simple as "playing on the beat" can be quite tricky. First, there is our understanding, our cognition of what "on the beat" means and sounds like. Then, there is being able to actually do it, to sing or clap that rhythm. When we introduce our instruments to the equation, things get even more difficult. Finally, add in the fact that we are improvising our melodies, not just reading notes off the page, and this "simple task" becomes almost impossibly hard.

We really have just two options - playing ON the beat, and playing OFF the beat. When we learn how to quantize our rhythms, make them either one or the other, the quality of our playing can get orders of magnitude better, in very short order. ON, or OFF.

#1 - Downbeats



#2 - Upbeats



#3 - Etude over "Solar" chord changes



#3 - Etude in Bb

Three staves of musical notation for a jazz piece. The first staff contains measures 1-4 with chords Dm6, Am7, and D7. The second staff contains measures 5-8 with chords Gmaj7, Gm7, and C7(b9). The third staff contains measures 9-12 with chords Fmaj7, Fm7, Bb7(b9), Ebmaj7, Eø7, and A7(b9).

#3 - Etude in Eb

Am⁶ Em⁷ A⁷

Dmaj⁷ Dm⁷ G7(b⁹)

Cmaj⁷ Cm⁷ F7(b⁹) Bbmaj⁷ Bbø⁷ E7(b⁹)

#3 - Etude in Bass Clef

Cm⁶ Gm⁷ C⁷
 Fmaj⁷ Fm⁷ Bb⁷(b⁹)
 Ebmaj⁷ Ebm⁷ Ab⁷(b⁹) Dbmaj⁷ D^ø_b⁷ G⁷(b⁹)